

INVESTIGATION REPORT

Issue 1019: Ready handshake in the divide and square-root unit

openhwgroup/cv32e40p

Document	RTL-TRIAGE-CV32E40P-1019
Disposition	Dead code, proven
Record date	2026-09-17
Classification	Internal working document. Not a verification sign-off.

1

Status

Issue	openhwgroup/cv32e40p#1019
Issue type	Coverage hole referred for disposition
Affects	cv32e40p
Configuration	RTL 6033d2b, COREV_PULP=1 FPU=1 (the upstream PULP_F0 configuration), top cv32e40p_formal_top, yosys-slang frontend
Disposition	Dead code, proven
Severity	Not assessed
Agreement	Same disposition as the independent human record.
Evidence	4 cited, 4 present

Disposition meaning. The code cannot be reached in any state permitted by the stated model and assumptions, established by an unbounded proof.

Severity is not recorded for this run. The harness does not infer a severity from the disposition, so the field is reported as not assessed rather than filled in.

2

Description

The uncovered branch at fpnew_divsqrt_th_32.sv:287 and 288 is unreachable. Line 286 opens the case where a new operation starts while the unit is ready; line 287 asks whether a write-back is completing in the same cycle, and line 288 keeps the unit ready if so. The unit cannot both accept a new operation and retire an old one in the same cycle, so line 288 is never executed. An unbounded proof (abc pdr, top cv32e40p_formal_top, COREV_PULP=1 FPU=1) passes in 23.0 s with the checker bound into the fpnew_divsqrt_th_32 instance inside the CV32E40P FPU wrapper, not standalone. A bounded cover run reaches the line 286 antecedent at step 12, so the assertion is not vacuous. This is the same property as the upstream assert_unreachable_divsqrt_th_288, checked with a different tool chain.

3

Conditions

1. legal OBI handshakes on both the instruction and the data interface
2. scan_cg_en_i=0
3. no CSR write to the hardware-loop CSRs (0xCC0, 0xCC1, 0xCC2, 0xCC4, 0xCC5, 0xCC6)
4. clock gates modelled as transparent
5. every trace starts in reset
6. instruction memory contents otherwise unconstrained

Reproduced from the assumes that are enabled in the upstream formal environment at cores/cv32e40p/scripts/formal/src, plus the two modelling choices the open-source flow requires.

4 Implications

Not recorded as a separate field for this run. What the disposition means for a user of the core follows from the Disposition meaning in Status and the bounds in Limitations and scope.

5 Action

Waiver text, to be applied to the coverage exclusion

fpnew_divsqrt_th_32.sv:287-288 (unit_ready_d held high when a write-back completes in the same cycle a new operation starts): formally proven unreachable (abc pdr, unbounded, bound into the fpnew_divsqrt_th_32 instance inside cv32e40p_formal_top, COREV_PULP=1 FPU=1, RTL 6033d2b). op_starting with unit_ready_q and ex2_inst_wb with ex2_inst_wb_vld_q are mutually exclusive. Assumptions: legal OBI handshakes on both interfaces, scan_cg_en_i=0, no CSR write to the hardware-loop CSRs, transparent clock gates. Evidence: runs/v1-cv32e40p-1019/formal/p_assert/sby.log (PASS) and formal/c_antecedent/sby.log (antecedent reached at step 12).

Checker used

checker_1019.sv

6 Evidence

Ref	Type	Path, relative to the run directory	File	Result recorded
E1	proof	formal/p_assert/sby.log	present	abc pdr PASS (23.0 s, COREV_PULP=1 FPU=1): op_starting with unit_ready_q never coincides with ex2_inst_wb and ex2_inst_wb_vld_q
E2	proof	formal/p_assert/result.json	present	machine-readable status record for the proof job
E3	proof	formal/c_antecedent/sby.log	present	smtbmc/yices cover PASS (32.7 s, depth 80): op_starting with unit_ready_q is reached at step 12 inside the real FPU instance, so a_divsqrt288 is not vacuous
E4	proof	formal/c_antecedent/result.json	present	machine-readable status record for the cover job

Paths are relative to runs/v1-cv32e40p-1019. The File column is a check made when this document was generated. It reports whether the cited file exists, not whether its contents were re-validated. 'not kept' means a repository rule deliberately excludes that artefact, usually a waveform dump; rerun the check to regenerate it. 'MISSING' means the file is absent and was expected to be there.

What each class of artefact establishes

- proof. Proof or engine run. Scope depends on the mode: prove is unbounded under the stated model, bmc is bounded to its depth, cover establishes reachability only.

7 Limitations and scope

- The proof establishes unreachable under the model and the environment assumptions named in Status and Conditions. It does not establish that the surrounding logic is correct.
- This is an internal investigation record. It requires engineering review before it is used as a disposition. No report generator can supply missing evidence.
- Results apply to the configuration and core revision named in Status. A different configuration needs a separate run.
- Measured tool time is the time the tools ran. It is not an engineering effort figure and not a turnaround commitment.
- Public demonstration runs on open cores are not client engagements and not production verification results.

8 Provenance and measurement

Run directory runs/v1-cv32e40p-1019
Inputs shown title, body(links stripped), labels
Human record Dolphin Design 2024: waived in v2; reported proven unreachable with Siemens

Assessed confidence

Iterations

Questa Static formal, assertion assert_unreachable_divsqrt_th_288
0.9. This is the investigator's own estimate. It is not a measurement and not a reliability figure.
1

Measured tool and step time

Step	Measured
prove	23.0 s
cover	32.7 s
Total	55.7 s

Times are wall-clock for the step named. Some steps may have run concurrently, so they do not sum to an isolated performance figure, and they are not an engineering effort measure.

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